

# LINUX AND MAC: QT CREATOR

Same IDE, a compiler that's already on your system

RECOMMENDED

## Qt Creator on Linux and Mac

Same reasoning as Windows: it's free, cross-platform, and reads the same `CMakeLists.txt` every lecture in this course ships with. Install it via the Qt Online Installer, selecting just the Qt Creator component.

## Qt Creator will pick your system compiler

Unlike Windows, Linux and Mac almost always already have a C++ compiler installed system-wide:

- Linux - usually GCC, already on the system or one `apt / dnf / pacman` install away.
- Mac - Apple Clang, installed as part of the Xcode Command Line Tools (`xcode-select --install`).

Qt Creator detects it automatically and creates a Kit for you - in most cases, you won't need to configure a Kit by hand at all.

## THE CATCH

### That default compiler might be old

Your distro's or macOS's system compiler is whatever version shipped when your OS was released or last updated - not necessarily the latest GCC or Clang. This course is written against **C++23**, which needs a fairly recent compiler.

A system GCC/Clang that's a few years old may not build every example in this course - that's not a mistake on your part, it's just what "the default compiler" means.

## CHECKING YOUR VERSION

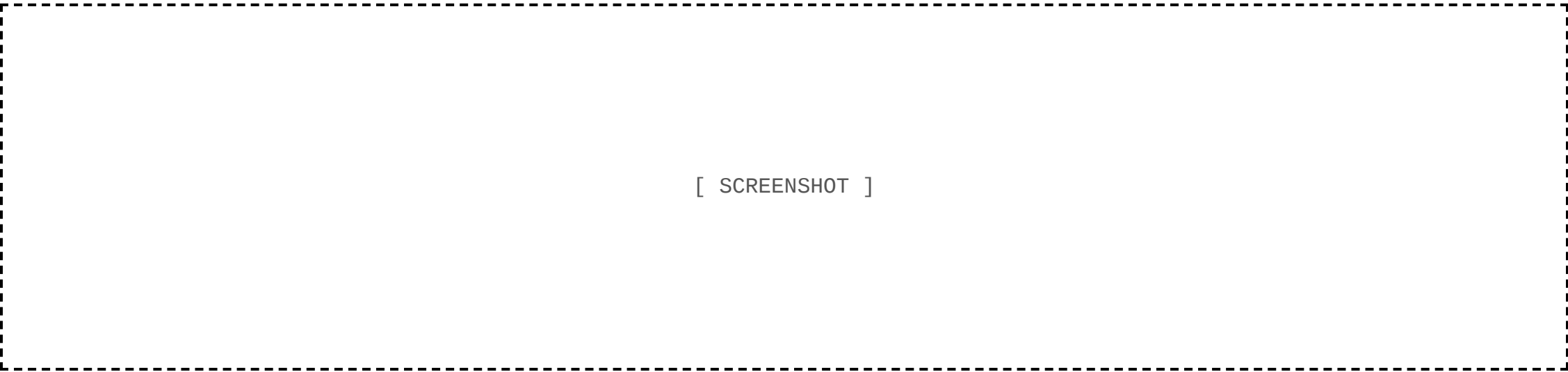
### Check before you assume

```
g++ --version  
clang++ --version
```

Compare what you get against  
[cppreference's compiler support table](#)  
(lecture 2.5 covers this in depth).

OPENING THIS LECTURE

## Building this lecture's program



[ SCREENSHOT ]

**File -> Open File or Project**, select this folder's **CMakeLists.txt**, confirm the detected Kit, then **Configure Project**. Build and run **rooster** the same way you would any Qt Creator project.

IF IT'S TOO OLD

## If your compiler turns out to be too old

You don't need to upgrade your whole system compiler just for this course. Lecture 2.6 covers **Docker** - a way to get a modern GCC or Clang without touching anything already installed.